



ANIL DAYAL

VINTAGE COURTYARD



HERITAGE VILLAGE PRAGPUR, HIMACHAL PRADESH

AT THE
CENTRE OF
PRAGPUR'S
CHARM IS
THE JUDGE'S
COURT, A
93-YEAR-OLD
COUNTRY
HOME.

It's an idyllic hideaway steeped in history. On the Chandigarh-Dharamshala road, Pragpur emerges like a delightful discovery. Nestling in the wooded foothills of the verdant Kangra valley in the backdrop of the majestic Dhauladhar range of mountains, Pragpur is a picture-perfect place where the cobbled streets along centuries-old, well-preserved dwellings evoke an ambience of medieval age. Quaint and quiet, India's only heritage village, Pragpur was granted the status in 1998 by the Himachal Pradesh government to preserve its past and to promote it as a showpiece of heritage tourism. It has since been attracting a rising number of visitors, mostly foreigners. Sample the visitors' comments—"an unexpected little jewel in the countryside", "an oasis of tranquility", and "the Garden of Eden",—and you realise that Pragpur is fascinating even 300 years after it was set up in the memory of Princess Pragdevi or Pragrani, who is believed to have fought against Muslim rulers.

by Ramesh Vinayak